Franklin Crypto Research Competition — UBC 2026

Track: **Short, market cap > $1B**

Short PUMP: I Ran Bots Inside Token Factories

Asset: PUMP (pump.fun)

Jean-Baptiste Durand, solo

42 Blockchain

contact: jbdurand2000@gmail.com

data and code: github.com/JeanBaptisteDurand/UBC_Research_Competition

November 2026

Disclosure. From September 23 to October 13, 2026, I personally ran small automated trading bots on launchpad pools across four chains, with $56–122 of outside capital (Appendix C). I do not hold any position in PUMP or SOL.

AI use: an AI assistant helped me draft and translate this report from my notes in French, and helped check the numbers, the sources, the Allium queries (on definitions I set beforehand), the scripts and the figures. The key ideas, the collector, the bots, the thesis and the decisions are my own.

Main report: 5 pages (executive summary = page 1). Title page, references and appendices are outside the page count. Figures 1–5 are in the main text; Table B1 and Figures A1 and D3 are in the appendices.

Executive summary

Launchpads have become one of crypto's busiest businesses. Anyone can mint a token in seconds on a "bonding curve", and this year's new chains brought "token factories" with them: operators who mint pools by the hundred and drain them. pump.fun is the largest launchpad, and PUMP is priced as if this summer's boom were the new normal. I believe it is not. Its typical buyer loses money and has started to leave, while the price still rests on one record week. The buyback that holds it up stops in April 2027. I am short PUMP against SOL, with a target of $0.0022 by April 2027.

What I did. From September 23 to October 13 I ran small trading bots myself, from 53 addresses on four chains, with about a hundred dollars of capital, and made +$748 (Appendix C). The operators adapted: my edge lasted three weeks on Arc and only four days on Robinhood Chain. The real value was the proof that my replay engine matches real trades (page 2). I then used the same tools on every trade of pump.fun's curve for sixteen days.

PUMP — SHORT · Price $0.00474 (Oct 21, 2026, ref. 2) · **Target $0.0022, –54 %: today's 2.6× multiple on pre-boom revenue ($398M a year, Feb–Jun) = $1.03B market cap** · Market cap $2.19B = 2.6× run-rate revenue · 50 % of revenue buys back PUMP for one year, changeable by one address · Trade: short PUMP perpetual / long SOL, same amount, no leverage, 1 % of the book · Horizon: April 2027 (key test: Nov 16 weekly print) · What would prove me wrong: weekly revenue ≥ $16M for 4 weeks, buyers > 155k/day (Allium, 7-day mean) for 2 weeks, or launchpad fees ≥ $58M/wk · Catastrophe stop: PUMP/SOL ×2 on a daily close

#1. The crowd loses, and it is leaving. For sixteen days in October my collector recorded every trade on pump.fun's bonding curve for SOL-quoted tokens, 1.69 million positions. The "fish" who buy twenty to sixty seconds after a launch lost a median **17.4 %** per position, and the median was negative on every one of the sixteen days, while a round trip costs only 2.5 % in fees. Allium, an independent second pipeline, finds −13 % for the same crowd, and the same loss in three earlier fortnights going back to February, with medians between −12 % and −15 % (Appendix A). It is not random, it is how the product works. And the crowd is now leaving. On Allium's count active buyers fell **16 %** in one week, and four weeks after their late-September peak they were 36 % lower, back near their pre-boom level (Fig. 1, Fig. A1).

#2. Priced for one peak week. Before the summer, pump.fun earned about **$7.7M a week** (February to June). The peak week reached **$17.9M**, and revenue has been falling since: **$14.0M** in the last full week of my October 21 snapshot, and $9.7M in the week to November 8 (DefiLlama). After each of the two earlier peaks, revenue fell by **87 %** in six months and by **52 %** in nine (Fig. 4). At today's multiple of 2.6 times revenue, the pre-boom base is worth **$0.0022** a token, and PUMP has already lost about a quarter of its price since October 21.

#3. The only programmed buyer has an end date. Half of revenue goes to buying back and burning PUMP under a one-year policy that ends around April 28, 2027 (refs 6, 10), with no obligation to renew and a share that one address can change without a vote (ref. 7). Since the token launched in July 2025, buybacks have taken **$490.7M** of PUMP, more than a fifth of the market cap, and since PUMP pays no dividend they are the only way revenue reaches holders (ref. 20). Meanwhile **6.875B tokens a month** unlock to a team and investors who paid little or nothing for them (ref. 8). Over the last month these unlocks were already larger than the buybacks.

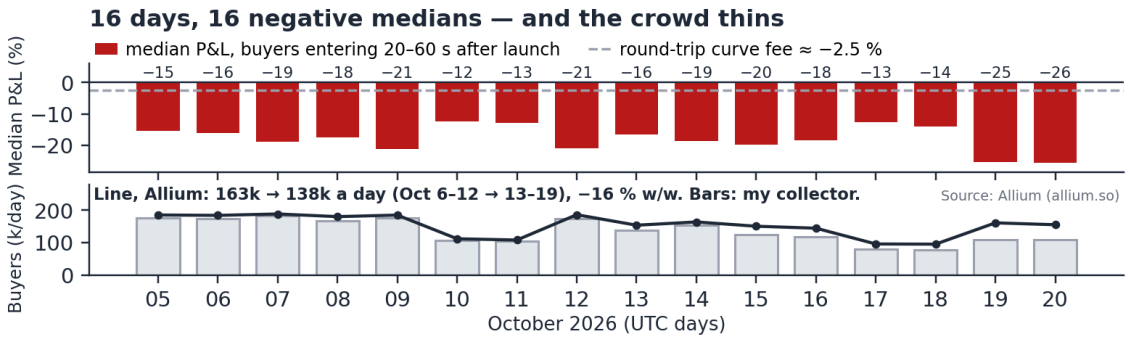


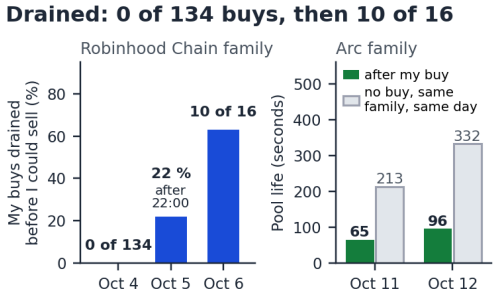
Fig. 1 — The crowd's median position lost money on each of the sixteen days. Top: median P&L of the crowd's positions. Bottom: active buyers per day, my collector (bars) along with Allium (line). My collector undercounts after October 14, so weekly buyer counts are Allium's. The two pipelines agree on the direction of every measure, not on most levels (Appendix A). Sources: my collector; Allium query q1 (ref. 19).

Project overview (1): how I worked

I measured before I acted. My own data collector, which watches 35 EVM chains and Solana, first showed that most new pools on the newest chains came from a few "token factories". Only then did I build the bots. I wrote all the rules down before testing: a method note dated September 11, in the repository, fixed the rule and its thresholds in advance, and the October rules are timestamped to the minute. I also made the replays earn my trust. One factory family looked like +198 % at the last logged price, but at the real on-chain state of that moment it was −18.9 % (Appendix A).

The factories were no secret. Most new pools on those chains were built to be drained. I looked for an indicator that could group pools by operator and spot them early, and found that pools sharing one contract bytecode belong to the same operator. My recipe was simple: buy $0.10–0.20 of a pool 20 to 45 seconds after it is created, not earlier so as not to hold too large a share, and sell 110 to 240 seconds later, before the drain. Run on four chains, it made **+$682 to +$748** over the campaign (Appendix C), and my replay matched the real results almost exactly: $53.5 a day replayed against $53.1 a day earned, over about five hundred round trips.

The operators fought back, and fast (Fig. 2). On Robinhood Chain, with nothing changed on my side, the share of my buys drained before I could sell went from none of 134 on October 4 to 22 % the next day and 10 of 16 on October 6. That evening the whole family stopped launching at 18:44 UTC and came back three days later. The same night, none of 166 buys by other traders in pools I did not touch was drained, which is my control. On Arc the defence was a "stake wall": buys of a quarter dollar or more were drained within seconds 156 times out of 157, while my ten-cent buys almost never were, and a week later pools of the family I was buying died 65 seconds after my buy, against 213 seconds without me. These families behave like small businesses with written rules. One rule I had written in advance missed its own threshold, so I never deployed it.



Family = pools sharing one bytecode. Oct 5: n not logged.
Nothing changed on my side Oct 4–6. Source: bot journals, collector.

Fig. 2 — How the operators answered my bots: the share of my buys drained before I could sell (one Robinhood Chain family, three days in a row), and how long a pool lived after my buy compared with pools I left alone (one Arc family). All wallets were swept to one public vault at the end (Appendix C). The day-by-day picture of both families is in the repository.

This does not price PUMP yet. Two things carry over to pump.fun. The first is the method, proven with real money. The second is a result: the recipe that worked on Arc, replayed on pump.fun's exact curve, does not make money. All nine of its variants were negative on all sixteen days, with medians between −2.7 % and −7.3 %. On pump.fun there is no operator to beat. The crowd simply pays a fee on every trade.

Project overview (2): pump.fun under my instrument

The business. pump.fun earns on four products: the bonding curve, PumpSwap (where graduated tokens trade), the Terminal and the mobile app, and since mid-October perpetuals routed to Hyperliquid. PumpSwap now takes more fees than the curve ($106M in September against $46M), though liquidity providers and creators keep part of them. My own crowd numbers cover the SOL-quoted curve. The company behind it, Baton Corporation Ltd, is registered in England, with Noah Tweedale and Alon Cohen among its directors. It raised $1.32B in July 2025 at $0.004 a token, and its annual accounts were overdue at the time of the Blockworks filing (ref. 7).

Sixteen days of every trade (October 5–20, 2026). In sixteen days, 395,253 SOL-quoted tokens were launched, about a thousand an hour, and half of them found a second buyer within a minute, a count that includes scripted buyers. Activity is high. Outcomes are poor: the median position lost 13.3 % across all entry times, and **17.4 %** for the crowd that enters 20 to 60 seconds after launch. The loss holds on all sixteen days however it is counted (strict P&L, or −15 % if unsold tokens are valued at the last curve price, Appendix A). The clearest scripted pattern is a creator who sells within seconds of an outside buy about twice as often as at comparable moments (×2.1 after controls, Appendix A). The same scanner read four other launchpads (Table B1, Appendix B).

The crowd is thinning. On Allium's count, active buying addresses went from 163,000 a day in the week of October 6 to 138,000 the next week, while SOL itself lost only 8 %. My collector missed a growing share of the flow after October 14, so here I use Allium's count (Appendix A). Nine months of Allium data put the peak behind us: 192,000 buyers a day in the week of September 28, and 122,000 four weeks later (Fig. A1). PumpSwap, the part I do not measure myself, is 30 % below its peak week in fees, and its buyers fell by a fifth from September to late October.

The food chain, hand by hand (Fig. 3). I grouped the 1.13 million buying addresses by how many positions each took in the sixteen days. The "fish", the 45 % who bought only once, lost a median **46 %.** The 395 busiest addresses, mostly bots with more than two thousand positions each, lost **4 %**, a little more than the fee. Nobody wins on the median. Small fish, with five positions or fewer, are 84 % of the addresses but put in only 11 % of the SOL, while the "whales", the 1.4 % with more than a hundred positions, put in **62 %.**

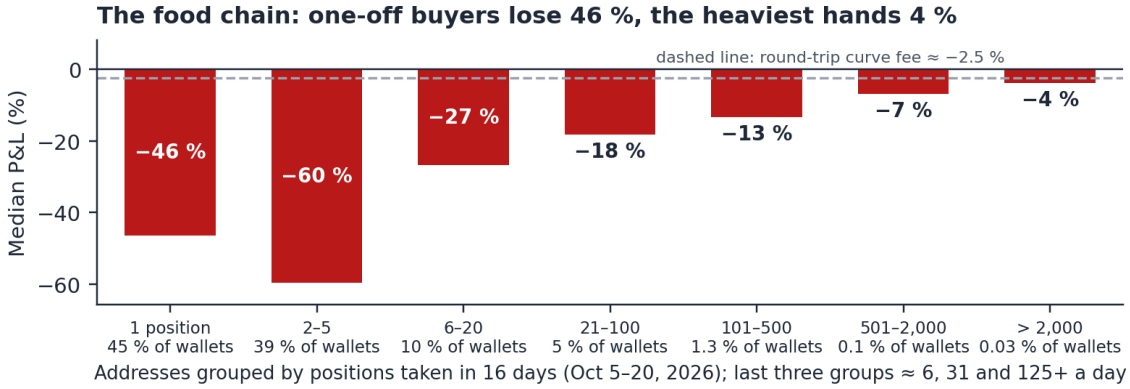


Fig. 3 — The food chain: median P&L per position, by the number of positions an address took in the sixteen days. Source: my Solana collector, which undercounts the second week (Appendix A). It covers 9.68M positions on tokens that did not graduate, scored with strict P&L.

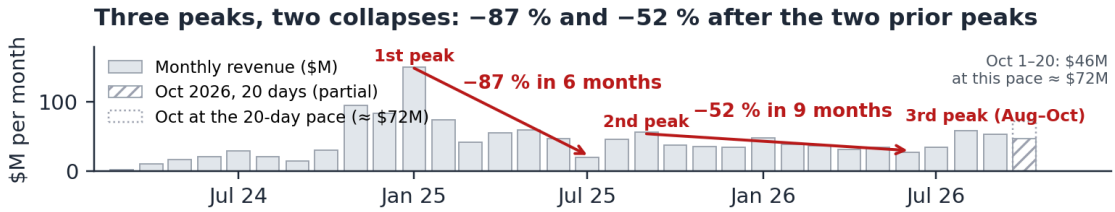
Two public facts (ref. 1, Fig. D3). First, pump.fun now keeps less of each dollar it processes. Fees grew 2.5 times this summer but revenue only doubled, partly by decision (creator rewards, Project Ascend) and partly because PumpSwap grew. Second, the pie shrank (Fig. D3). Across the launchpads alone, weekly fees went from $6.5M in June to $85M in early September, and back to $26M by mid-October. pump.fun kept at least half of launchpad revenue the whole time (ref. 20) and 70–94 % of Solana launchpad swaps (ref. 19), even if Pons took more fees than pump.fun for a few weeks around the peak. pump.fun is still the leader. The market it leads is what is shrinking.

Investment proposal (1): what it is worth

Comparables (market cap ÷ last 30 days of revenue, annualised, October 21). PUMP **2.6×** (between 1.6× and 4.2× over the past year) · PONS 3.2× · RAY 10× · JUP 18.3× · HYPE 22×. On paper PUMP is the cheapest of the group, and on the cash it returns to holders it trades at 5.2 times its yearly buybacks, against about 22 for HYPE. I believe the discount is deserved: the market already doubts that this revenue will last, and my data says it is right.

Target, two methods. *A multiple on base revenue.* Before the boom (February to June 2026), all of pump.fun's revenue (curve, PumpSwap, Terminal and app, ref. 1) averaged $398M a year. At today's 2.6×, that is a market cap of $1.03B, or **$0.0022 a token (−54 %)**. I see 2.6× as generous, because the multiple moves with revenue: it was 1.9× at the June low. On 90 days of revenue the market pays 3.2×, which would give $0.0028, the top of my range. I take the low end, because at base revenue the unlocks exceed the buybacks, and the buyback policy ends in April. *A buyback-coverage price*, a stress test with no multiple. It is the price at which half of revenue absorbs a year of unlocks. At the peak run-rate that price is $0.0051, within 7 % of today. At base revenue it falls to **$0.0024**. Both methods move with revenue, so their agreement proves little on its own. What matters is where revenue goes, and the series I track point down.

Revenue base ↓ / multiple →	1.9× (June 2026)	2.6× (today, 30-day basis)	3.2× (today on a 90-day basis; PONS today)
June-2026 trough, $319M/yr	$0.0013	$0.0018	$0.0022
Feb–Jun 2026 average, $398M/yr	$0.0016	**$0.0022**	$0.0028
Trailing 12 months, $465M/yr	$0.0019	$0.0026	$0.0032
Last full week, $728M/yr	$0.0030	$0.0041	$0.0050
Peak run-rate, $836M/yr	$0.0034	$0.0047 (today)	$0.0058



Source: DefiLlama dailyRevenue, pump.fun parent protocol (launchpad, PumpSwap, Terminal, app), Mar 2024 – Oct 20, 2026; October partial (hatched).

Fig. 4 — Three peaks, two collapses: pump.fun monthly revenue since March 2024 (October partial). The weekly series peaked in the last week of September and is –22 % since. Source: DefiLlama (ref. 1), series as of October 21, 2026.

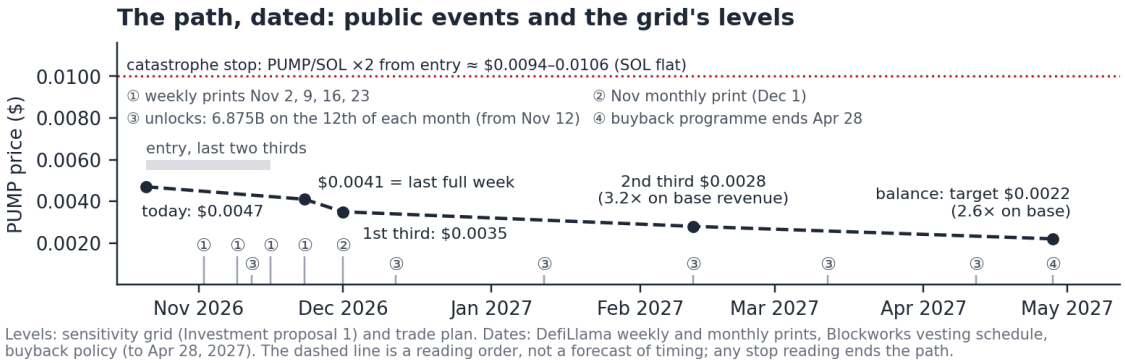
Scenarios (six months). Bear, 25 %: $0.0013, if revenue and its multiple fall back to their June lows and the buyback is not renewed. Base, 50 %: $0.0022. Bull, 25 %: the boom settles near $15M a week and the market pays 3.25×, $0.0055. Weighted by these odds, the price is about $0.0028. Appendix D runs the reverse check on today's price.

Net supply, and who holds it. PUMP pays no dividend and gives no vote on the buyback (refs 7, 20). The buyback is worth 19 % of the market cap a year at the run-rate and 9 % at base revenue. It is the bulls' best argument, and it has an end date. Each month 6.875B tokens (about $32.6M) unlock to the team and investors (refs 7–8). Insiders kept 92 % of the July cliff (ref. 9), so I treat unlocks as steady supply pressure and use their dates as signposts. Over the last month $29.5M was bought back and $32.6M unlocked, a net buyback yield (ref. 14) of −1.7 % a year if every unlocked token is counted. Ownership is concentrated. The ten largest addresses hold 59 % of all PUMP, and Solscan labels two thirds of that as pump.fun's own accounts. At the other end, the 430,000 holders outside the top thousand hold 1.3 % between them (refs 4, 19). Most of the rest sits in multisig vaults and large unlabelled wallets that hold rather than sell, so the real float is about a third (ref. 4).

Investment proposal (2): risks and trade

Tested and rejected (or not settled). *The crowd always lost, and pump.fun survived two collapses.* True. My claim is that this crowd is thinning while the price assumes it stays. *The crowd is rotating back to pump.fun.* Its share of launchpad revenue and swaps did rebound (refs 19–20), but the pie is far smaller than at the peak and buyers are 36 % below theirs. That is one of my stop readings. *Fewer but richer buyers.* On Allium's count, revenue per active buyer was flat in the week (+1 %) but still about 60 % above its February–June level, while the number of buyers is almost back to its own. So my target needs each buyer to spend less. That spend sat at $8–10 a buyer-day from February to July and rose only with the boom. The one earlier bump, in May ($12), was gone within four weeks (DefiLlama ÷ Allium, refs 1, 19). *The volume is wash trading.* About 1.3 % of pump.fun volume, on the strict lower bound (ref. 15). I claim the opposite: the volume is real and it loses money, which is worse for how long the revenue lasts.

Catalysts, dated (Fig. 5). The weekly prints of November 2, 9, 16 and 23: a week near $14M is worth $0.0041 at a constant multiple, and I take the first third of the profit below that, at $0.0035. The November monthly print on December 1, the first full month after the peak. The monthly unlock on the 12th, while revenue drifts toward its base ($0.0028 at the higher multiple, the second third). Then the end of the one-year buyback, about April 2027, with no guarantee of renewal ($0.0022, the rest). Regulation is a tail risk I do not price: a RICO claim against the company survived a motion to dismiss on August 31, 2026 (ref. 11), and UK users have been blocked since a regulator's warning (ref. 12).



Levels: sensitivity grid (Investment proposal 1) and trade plan. Dates: DefiLlama weekly and monthly prints, Blockworks vesting schedule, buyback policy (to Apr 28, 2027). The dashed line is a reading order, not a forecast of timing; any stop reading ends the path.

Fig. 5 — The path, dated: public events of the next six months and the grid's levels; grey band = the last two thirds of the entry on a rebound to $0.0055–0.0060 by November 16. Sources: DefiLlama, Blockworks filing, buyback policy.

Trade. A pair: short the PUMP perpetual and long SOL for the same amount, no leverage, 1 % of the book. The Binance perpetual trades $222M a day and open interest across venues is $352M (ref. 3), so even a $10M short is a small slice of it, and funding currently pays the short. Entry: a third at the October 21 price ($0.0047), and two thirds on a rebound to $0.0055–0.0060 before the November 16 print, or at market after that print if it confirms (the table uses $0.0053). With this much volatility, any price stop within reach is noise. So I use a thesis stop, read on the public weekly revenue and on Allium's buyer count. A separate catastrophe stop closes the trade if the PUMP/SOL ratio doubles on a daily close.

Six-month package per $ of notional	PUMP leg	Package, funding net of SOL leg	Probability
Bear · Base · Bull (PUMP –72 % · –54 % · +16 %)	+75 % · +58 % · –4 %	+76 % · +59 % · –3 %	25 % · 50 % · 25 %
Catastrophe stop (pair ratio ×2)	–100 %	–99 %	12 % under my drift, 38 % with none (rough)

The table assumes an entry at $0.0053 and a SOL leg of the same size. PUMP's beta to SOL has run at 0.9–1.2, so the pair is close to beta-neutral. It also counts three months of funding at +8 %/yr. **This is a thesis trade. Weighted by my scenario odds it returns about +30 % of notional if revenue keeps drifting down as it did twice before (12 % chance of hitting the catastrophe stop), and about −8 % if the same scenarios face a stop as likely as for a ratio with no drift (38 %). Rough, and biased upward.**

Risk	Probability	Effect	Trigger	Response
The crowd returns and the multiple follows	medium	bull case $0.0055, or the stop	revenue ≥ $16M/wk for 4 weeks; buyers' 7-day mean > 155k/day (Allium) for 2 weeks	thesis stop
Take rate restored (it ticked up from 30 % to 37 % weekly since mid-September), buyback raised or topped up from the $1.32B raised (ref. 7)	low–medium	+20–40 %	weekly take rate above 40 %; config update	thesis stop; halve the position
Squeeze. Open interest equals 16 % of market cap after growing 3.6 times this summer, and about 14 % of the circulating supply sits on exchanges	medium	pair ratio ×2	listing, buyback news, SOL rally	catastrophe stop; 1 % of the book; no leverage
Funding turns against the short (seen Oct 17–19); product expansion (app, perpetuals) lifts revenue per buyer	medium	–15 to –25 % of notional; revenue holds while buyers fall	7-day funding below –20 %/yr; the monthly prints	halve the position; thesis stop, not crowd numbers

Conclusion

Short PUMP against SOL, to $0.0022, by April 2027. PUMP is priced as if October's crowd will stay and the buyback will run forever. I believe neither holds: my data shows the crowd leaving, and the buyback has an end date. I tested this market with my own money before writing about it, and if my thesis stops trigger on the public series, I will say I was wrong.

References

1. DefiLlama fees & revenue API, pump.fun and 15 other launchpads — https://api.llama.fi/summary/fees/pump?dataType=dailyRevenue ; accessed Oct 21 and Nov 9, 2026.
2. CoinGecko API, PUMP, SOL and comparables — https://api.coingecko.com/api/v3/coins/pump-fun/market_chart ; accessed Oct 21 and Nov 9, 2026.
3. Binance Futures API (funding, open interest), Hyperliquid API, CoinGlass — https://fapi.binance.com/fapi/v1/fundingRate, https://api.hyperliquid.xyz/info, https://www.coinglass.com/currencies/PUMP ; accessed Oct 21–22, 2026.
4. Solscan, PUMP holders (top 80 with labels) — https://solscan.io/token/pumpCmXqMfrsAkQ5r49WcJnRayYRqmXz6ae8H7H9Dfn ; read Oct 22, 2026.
5. Author's collector, bot journals, data and code — https://github.com/JeanBaptisteDurand/UBC_Research_Competition ; vault 0x7d85bF7a82470837A1d832e4fa503a7ebF20ca97 (Appendix C).
6. pump.fun, PUMP token page and fee documentation — https://pump.fun/pump-token, https://pump.fun/docs/fees ; read Oct 17–20, 2026.
7. Blockworks Token Transparency, PUMP filing (B1 v1.1, Sep 21, 2026) — https://blockworks.com/token-transparency/filing/pump ; read Oct 22, 2026.
8. Tokenomist, PUMP tokenomics and the July 12, 2026 cliff — https://tokenomist.ai/research/pump-tokenomics-what-the-july-12-2026-insider-cliff-means-for-a-fixed-1t-supply-2 ; DropsTab vesting — https://dropstab.com/coins/pump-fun/vesting.
9. 4Pillars, "PUMP insiders kept 92 % of the July unlock" — https://research.4pillars.io/en/data/content/pump-insiders-kept-92-of-the-july-unlock.
10. CoinDesk, buyback policy (Apr 29, 2026) — https://www.coindesk.com/markets/2026/04/29/pump-fun-burns-36-of-pump-supply-in-usd370-million-wipe-locks-50-revenue-into-ongoing-buybacks ; The Defiant — https://thedefiant.io/news/defi/pump-fun-s-pump-buybacks-top-usd400m-as-token-stays-flat.
11. Protos, *Aguilar v. Baton Corp* (Aug 31, 2026) — https://protos.com/solana-labs-dropped-from-burwick-laws-pump-fun-lawsuit/.
12. Cointelegraph, FCA warning (Dec 3, 2024) — https://cointelegraph.com/news/fca-issues-warning-bans-pump-fun-uk ; Decrypt — https://decrypt.co/295355/solana-pump-fun-bans-uk-users-regulator.
13. Delphi Digital, "Bigger than Binance" (Jul 10, 2025) — https://members.delphidigital.io/reports/bigger-than-binance-how-pump-funs-1-3b-raise-sets-up-cryptos-most-hated-rally ; Tang, Hirsch, Killmer (Cornell), "Pump.fun: the long degen bet", MBC 2025.
14. Token Terminal, key metrics — https://tokenterminal.com/articles/token-terminal-key-metrics-faq ; TokenIntel, net buyback yield — https://tokenintel.org/reports/buybacks-are-the-mechanism-not-the-moat-2026-06-02 ; CF Benchmarks — https://www.cfbenchmarks.com/blog/pricing-the-perp-dex-leader-a-valuation-framework-for-hyperliquid ; CoinShares — https://coinshares.com/us/insights/research-data/hyperliquid-primer-and-5-year-valuation-framework/.
15. Szwajcok et al., "Meme Coin Factories", arXiv 2609.10246 — https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.10246.
16. Marino et al., "Predicting the success of new crypto-tokens: the Pump.fun case", arXiv 2602.14860 — https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.14860.
17. Ding, Luo, Xu, "Decompose Market Manipulation Strategies", SBFC 2025 — https://sbfc.sydney.edu.au/2025/papers/SBFC2025_4G3_P154.pdf.
18. Kamat, "Do Two On-Chain Observation Pipelines See the Same Tokens?", arXiv 2609.18975 — https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.18975.
19. Allium Explorer, public queries: q1 https://app.allium.so/s/OTno0JfpQFp077eJY5YTJg · q1b https://app.allium.so/s/XaiMvOaNZ7iDnTkM-DpzHA · q2 https://app.allium.so/s/zliyTYXOn1IcA3NJ57Tz1w · q3 https://app.allium.so/s/uB82BHSqTK_TlLxwy1CNAw · q4 https://app.allium.so/s/QzEkzrtdR7w5SeVC612_HQ ; q4b–d run Nov 9, 2026 (ref. 5).
20. Blockworks Research API, pump.fun revenue, buybacks and launchpad revenue — https://app.blockworks.com ; accessed Oct 31, 2026.

Appendices (outside the 5-page count)

Tables, figures and sources behind the main text. Full notes, data and scripts: https://github.com/JeanBaptisteDurand/UBC_Research_Competition (ref. 5).

Appendix A — The instrument

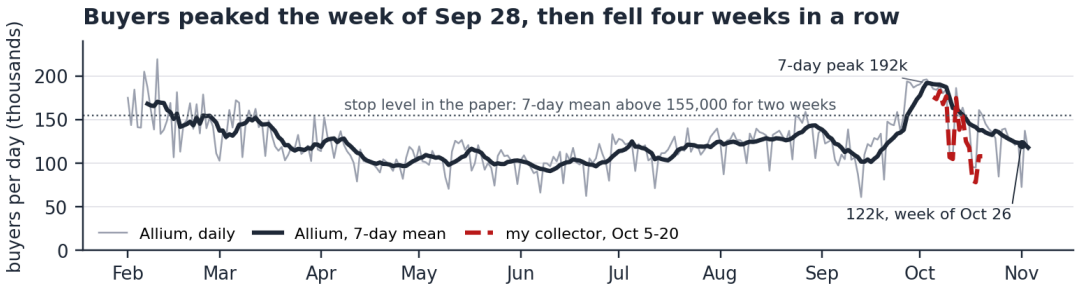
Measure	n	Result	Test
Crowd median P&L, entry 20–60 s, non-graduated tokens, Oct 5–20	1,691,317 positions	**–17.4 %** strict; –15.4 % valued at the last curve price; 95 % CI [–19.8 %; –16.0 %] (bootstrap of daily medians)	negative on 16/16 days ($p = 1.5 \times 10^{-5}$)
Hour by hour, exact-curve replay	384 hours	384/384 negative	count
Positive control: graduated tokens, birth to end of curve	9,916	×14.70 vs ×14.7 in theory	—
Creator sells within 3 s of an outside buy, vs matched control	2,780,579 outside buys	×2.1 (×1.8–4.6 by day)	above 1 on 16/16 days
Replay check, one factory family	—	+198 % at the last logged price, –18.9 % at the exact on-chain state	—
Factory pools tracked on Arc, Oct 4–21	7,160 addresses	93 % end negative (± 0.6 pt)	binomial

Cross-check with Allium (ref. 19): definitions and tolerances fixed and published before the first query.

measure, Oct 5–20	my collector	Allium	tolerance	verdict
buyers per day, Oct 6–12	155,300	163,333 (+5 %)	±10 %	pass
buyers per day, Oct 13–19	114,481	137,677 (+20 %)	±10 %	fail
week on week	–26 %	–16 %	within 5 points	fail (same sign, 7/7 pairs down in both)
crowd median, 20–60 s	–17.4 %	–13.2 %	±2 points	fail (same sign)
distinct buyers, 16 days	1,129,662	1,296,189 (+15 %)	±10 %	fail (coverage loss after Oct 14)

The crowd in three earlier fortnights (Allium, run on November 9, a stated departure from my rule 2).

Window (2026)	Crowd positions	Median strict P&L	Graduation rate	Second buyer ≤ 60 s
Feb 1–16	1,802,791	–15.0 %	0.8 %	65 %
May 1–16	1,571,731	–12.2 %	0.7 %	70 %
Aug 1–16	2,057,007	–13.6 %	2.2 %	69 %
Oct 5–20	2,249,019	–13.2 %	1.7 %	69 %



Source: Allium (allium.so), solana.dex.trades, protocol 'pumpfun'; a buyer is the signer of a swap that sells SOL. Query q2 in crosscheck/queries/allium/. Collector: docs/pumpfun/03 §10. The two agree within 3-11 % to Oct 14, then the collector loses coverage (crosscheck/results/allium/README.md).

Fig. A1 — Active buyers on the pump.fun curve, February 1 – November 3, 2026, Allium's count (daily and 7-day mean), with my collector's sixteen days. Second pipeline, not calibrated (above). Source: Allium (allium.so), query q2 (ref. 19).

Appendix B — Five launchpads under the same instrument

Table B1 — Five venues under the same scanner. The busiest launchpad still costs the crowd 17 % per position. Read signatures, not levels: the other venues are snapshots of a few hours to a day (Oct 4–8). Source: my collector; columns below.

Venue (chain)	Launches per hour	Second buyer ≤ 60 s	Crowd median P&L	Operator pull or sell within seconds of an outside buy (× matched control)	Inorganic signature
pump.fun (Solana), 16 days	**1,029**	**51 %**	**–17.4 %**	**×1.8–4.6 (×2.1 controlled)**	**12 % never trade; buyers –16 % w/w (Allium)**
PumpSwap (post-graduation, 19 h)	36–51 playable pools	100 %	–20.5 % night / +1.7 % day	none	virtual reserve counted in price
LaunchLab (Raydium, other quote tokens)	77	93 %	–23.2 %	×10.4	StonkFun = 95 % of September launches
Zora	138	56 %	–0.6 to –2 %	none (0 / 606)	one operator = 83 % of births
Pons V2	354	n/a	–5.9 % (3rd-party)	5 of 6 drained in 1.4 s	fees –43 % after gas subsidy ended

Appendix C — The campaign's money

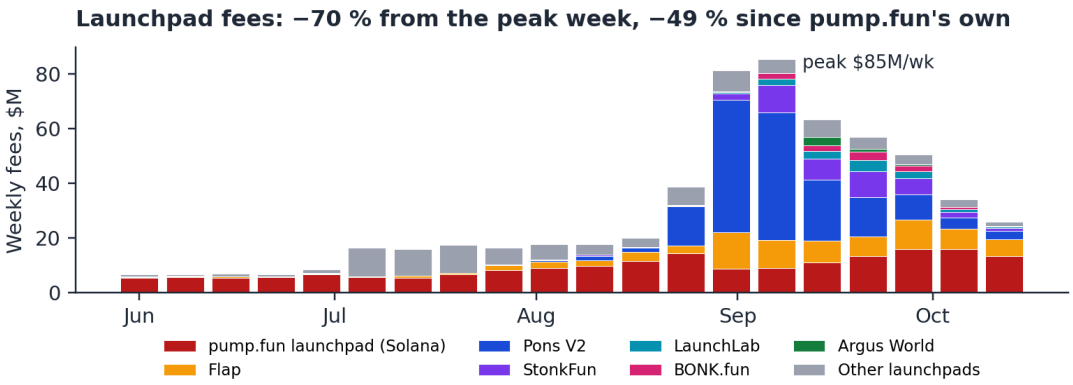
Item	Amount
External capital in	$55.66 (floor) to $122.46 (ceiling), Sep 23 – Oct 2
Recovered at the vault, Oct 13	≈ $804 (640.77 USDC + 0.042 ETH + 0.176 TAO)
Campaign net, Sep 23 → Oct 13, four chains	**+$682 to +$748**
Arc, Oct 3–12: journals vs balances	+$424 logged, +$474 in balances
Earlier tests on Pons (September)	≈ –0.26 ETH ≈ –$700
Overall, early September → Oct 13	≈ –$20 to +$50

Sweeps to the public vault 0x7d85bF7a82470837A1d832e4fa503a7ebF20ca97 on Arc:

- Oct 7, 2026 19:23 UTC — w000 → vault, 196.739407 USDC: `0x4278048243806f9effb75206445a33b6c29fb4519224220df66470b4b84c163a`
- Oct 7, 2026 19:23 UTC — w001 → vault, 178.116421 USDC: `0x4c6db445c8349f39b5b3e40b4ea30339b2127f1a7d7bb4ce2b601abc0aef73ed`
- Oct 13, 2026 21:56 UTC — f101 → vault, 143.872356 USDC: `0x99e5f0e954924dba3378e954fb8e67b2596e99d0de2edfe99093d4ce8812917e`
- Oct 13, 2026 21:56 UTC — f102 → vault, 110.408233 USDC: `0x8dd41acced7790ea74812702f9fc50cd1ff9e6d6b149bd66f692074f1e27cced`

Appendix D — Valuation arithmetic

Check	Arithmetic	Result
Target	2.6× × $398M (Feb–Jun 2026 revenue, annualised) = $1.04B ÷ 461.9B circulating tokens	**$0.0022 (–54 %)**
Reverse check (fully diluted)	FDV $3.92B ÷ holder flow $418M (50 % × $836M) = 9.4×; at a 25 % discount rate the price implies ≈ 14 %/yr growth forever	flat peak flows: FDV $1.67B (–57 %); base flows: $0.80B (–80 %)
Buyback coverage (no multiple)	P = 0.5 × annual revenue ÷ 82.5B tokens unlocked a year	$0.0051 at run-rate · $0.0024 at base · $0.0019 at the June trough



Source: DefiLlama dailyFees, 16 launchpads with >$0.3M fees/30d in October (all chains), pump.fun counted as its launchpad only; ISO weeks 23–42 of 2026. Universe fixed on October fees (earlier casualties absent).

Fig. D3 — Launchpad fees, launchpads only (16 venues, all chains; for pump.fun its launchpad, not PumpSwap, the Terminal or the app); −70 % from the pie's peak week (Sep 7), −49 % since pump.fun's (Sep 28). Pons is the largest slice of the peak week (57 %); universe fixed on October fees. Source: DefiLlama. Shares depend on how DefiLlama splits pump.fun's products, so I read this figure for the size of the pie only: on revenue across 43 venues pump.fun never fell below half (50.6 % at its lowest, week of September 7; Blockworks, ref. 20).

Appendix E — Reproducibility

Every number in the paper has a command in the repository (`check/check_numbers.py` , 55 checks): https://github.com/JeanBaptisteDurand/UBC_Research_Competition